



Certified Penetration Testing Professional

theHarvester Cheat Sheet

theHarvester

Source: <https://www.edge-security.com>

theHarvester is a simple, powerful, and effective tool used in the early stages of a penetration test or red team engagement. It is also used for open-source intelligence (OSINT) gathering to help determine a company's external threat landscape. It can gather emails, names, subdomains, IPs, and URLs using multiple public data sources.

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1. theHarvester Options

Syntax	
<code>theharvester options</code>	
Options	
<code>-d</code>	Domain to search or company name
<code>-b: data source</code>	Baidu, bing, bingapi, dogpile, google, googleCSE, googleplus, google-profiles, LinkedIn, pgp, twitter, vhost, yahoo, all
<code>-s</code>	Start in result number X (default: 0)
<code>-v</code>	Verify hostname via DNS resolution and search for virtual hosts
<code>-f</code>	Save the results into an HTML and XML file

-n	Perform a DNS reverse query on all ranges discovered
-c	Perform a DNS brute force for the domain name
-t	Perform a DNS TLD expansion discovery
-e	Use this DNS server
-l	Limit the number of results to work with (bing goes from 50 to 50 results, google 100 to 100)
-h	Use SHODAN database to query discovered hosts

2. theHarvester Passive Data Source

Data Source	Description
baidu	Baidu search engine - www.baidu.com
bing	Microsoft search engine - www.bing.com
bingapi	Microsoft search engine, through the API
dnsdumpster	DNSdumpster search engine - https://dnsdumpster.com/
dogpile	Dogpile search engine - www.dogpile.com
duckduckgo	DuckDuckGo search engine - www.duckduckgo.com
Exalead	Meta search engine - www.exalead.com/search
github-code	GitHub code search engine (Requires a GitHub Personal Access Token, see below.) - www.github.com
brave	Brave search engine - https://search.brave.com/
bufferoverun	Requires an API key - https://tls.bufferover.run
crtsh	Comodo Certificate search - https://crt.sh
hunter	Hunter search engine (Requires an API key, see below.) - www.hunter.io
intelx	Intelx search engine (Requires an API key, see below.) - www.intelx.io
hackertarget	Online vulnerability scanners and network intelligence to help organizations - https://hackertarget.com

hunterhow	Internet search engines for security researchers - https://hunter.how
otx	AlienVault Open Threat Exchange - otx.alienvault.com
securityTrails	Security Trails search engine, the world's largest repository of historical DNS data - www.securitytrails.com
shodan	Shodan search engine will search for ports and banners from discovered hosts - www.shodanhq.com
onyphe	Cyber defense search engine - https://www.onyphe.io/
rapiddns	DNS query tool which make querying subdomains or sites of a same IP easy! https://rapiddns.io
sitedossier	Find available information on a site - http://www.sitedossier.com
tomba	Tomba search engine - https://tomba.io
urlscan	Sandbox for the web that is a URL and website scanner - https://urlscan.io
vhost	Bing virtual hosts search
virustotal	virustotal.com domain search
yahoo	Yahoo search engine
pgp	PGP key server - pgp.rediris.es Example: theharvester -d microsoft.com -b pgp

3. theHarvester Active Data Source

Data Source	Description
DNS brute force	Runs dictionary brute force enumeration
DNS reverse lookup	Reverse lookup of IP's discovered to find hostnames
DNS TDL expansion	TLD dictionary brute force enumeration

4. theHarvester Commands

Command	Description
<code>theharvester -d microsoft.com -l 500 -b google</code>	Perform passive scanning on the target domain (Microsoft.com) by limiting the results to 500 (-l 500) using Google (-b)
<code>theharvester -d kali.org -l 500 -b google -f output.txt</code>	Perform passive scanning on the target domain (kali.org) by limiting the results to 500 (-l 500) using Google (-b) and saving the output to a text file (-f output.txt)
<code>theHarvester.py -d google.com -c -b google</code>	Perform active scanning and brute-forcing subdomains of the target domain (google.com) using option -c using Google (-b)